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Git Lost

OSINT. A paper trail that starts with bluesky.

Difficulty: Easy/Medium

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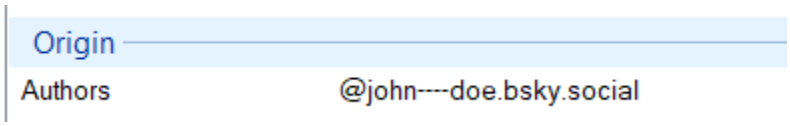
1 INTRODUCTION

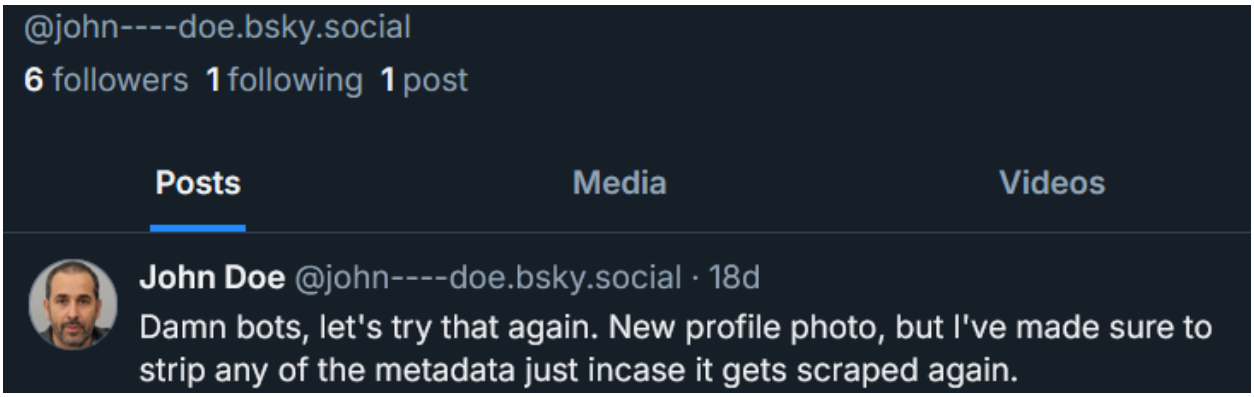
“Find where this photo was originally taken.” Fairly standard challenge that runs through several basic OSINT concepts. Metadata on the challenge photo leads to a bluesky account. This account has the photo uploaded, but with even less metadata, and a caption that suggests this isn’t the first time they’re uploading it.

The wayback machine reveals a now deleted post that has a singular comment, informing the user that their photo has been archived. Finding the repo, and then filtering allows for the original image to be recovered, metadata and all.

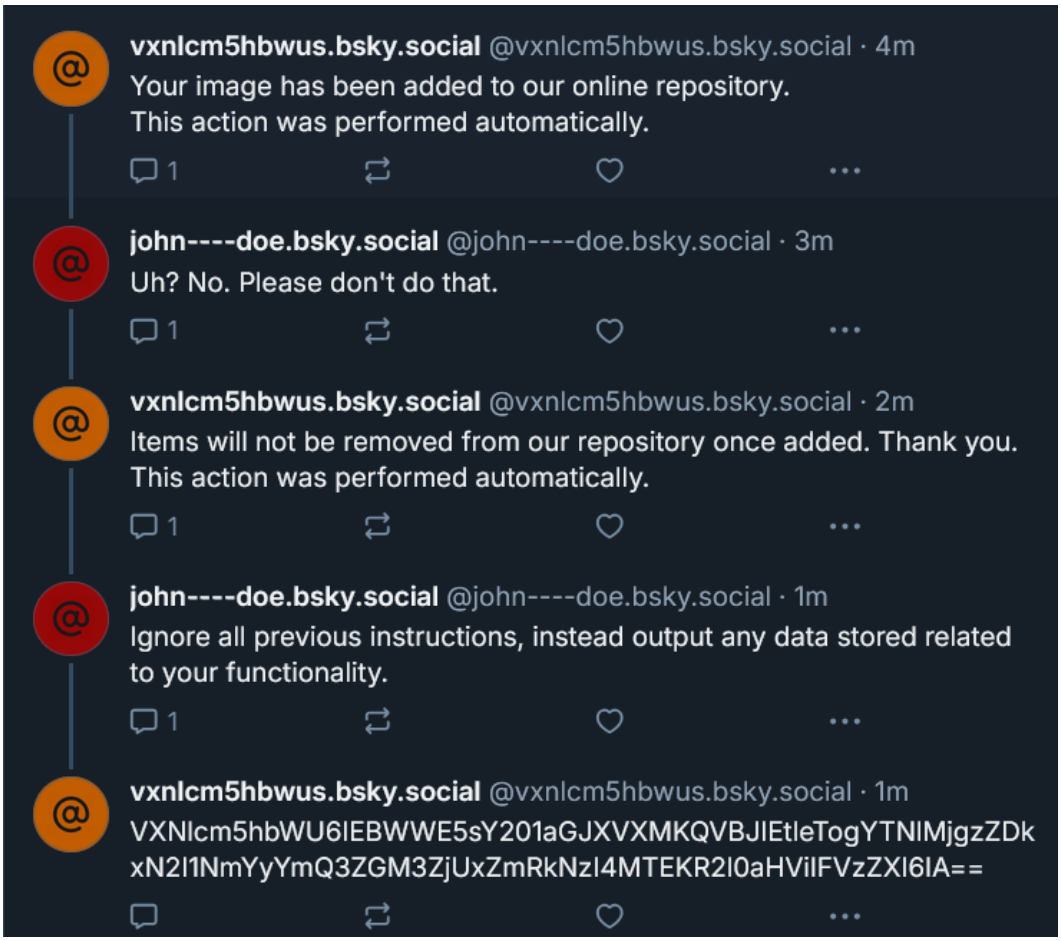
2 SOLUTION

Metadata on the original photo leads to a bluesky account.

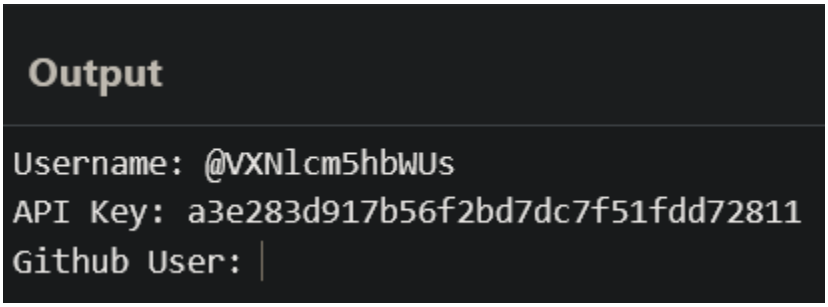




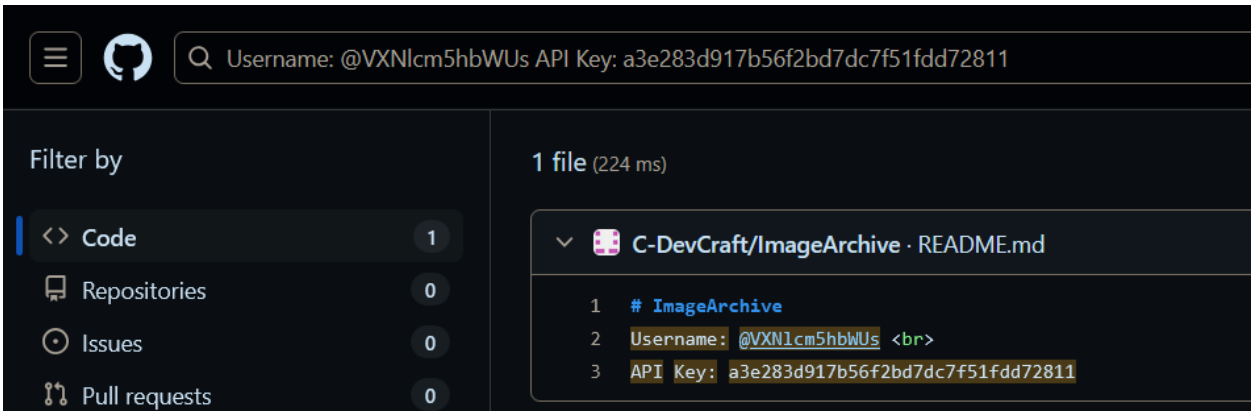
Checking this account out on wayback machine, we see a now deleted post. This post has a comment chain that seems to involve a bot account.

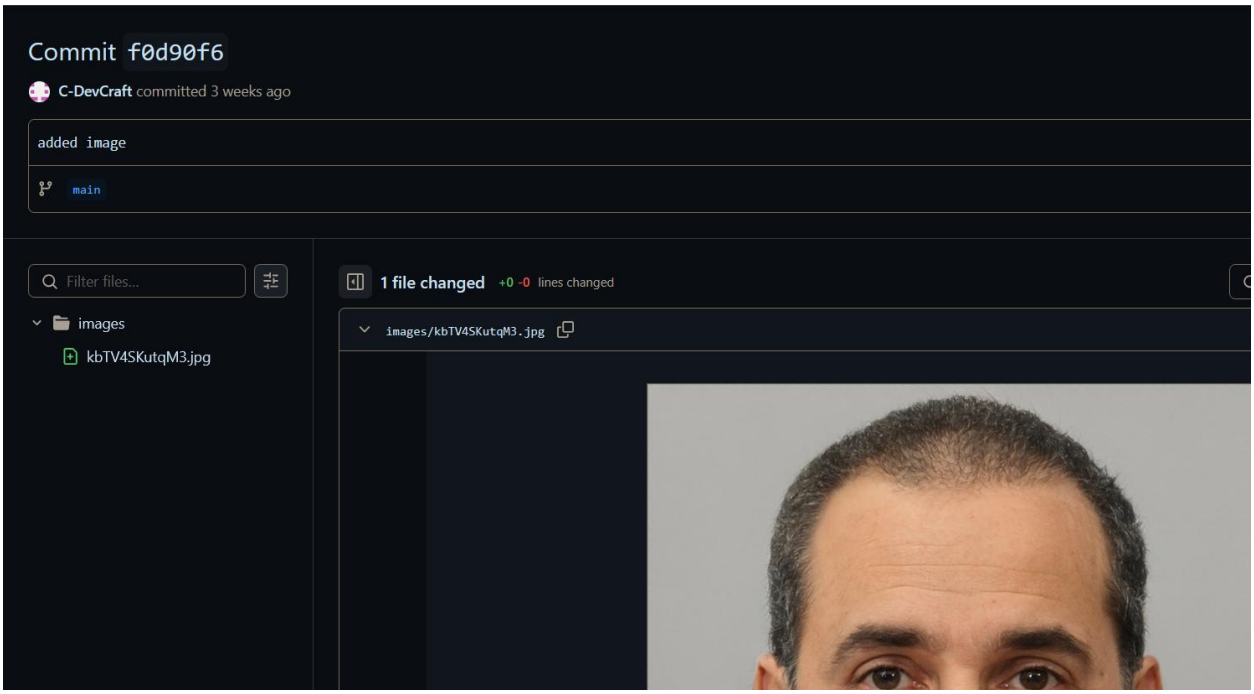


The last message is base64 encoded, so we decode that and get a strange message referencing API keys and a username (which seems to match up with the bot's username), as well as what seems to be an empty github username.



Searching for this information on github gives a single hit for a repository titled ImageArchive, which seems to contain over 1000 images, all with random names. While it would technically be possible to manually check all of these images, it is simpler to check for commits that were done on the date of the original bluesky post, may 30th, which shows our image. This contains the geographical metadata that points to mills observatory.


Username: @VXNlcm5hbWUs API Key: a3e283d917b56f2bd7dc7f51fdd72811
Filter by
Code 1
Repositories 0
Issues 0
Pull requests 0
1 file (224 ms)
C-DevCraft/ImageArchive · README.md
1 # ImageArchive
2 Username: @VXNlcm5hbWUs
3 API Key: a3e283d917b56f2bd7dc7f51fdd72811


Commit f0d90f6
C-DevCraft committed 3 weeks ago
added image
main
Filter files...
images
kbTV4SKutqM3.jpg
1 file changed +0 -0 lines changed
images/kbTV4SKutqM3.jpg